



Eyes in the sky

44ft (13.4m) upper wing helps plane reach altitude of 14,100ft (4,300m)



Caudron G.3 France 1914

Large, greenhouse-style canopy for good visibility



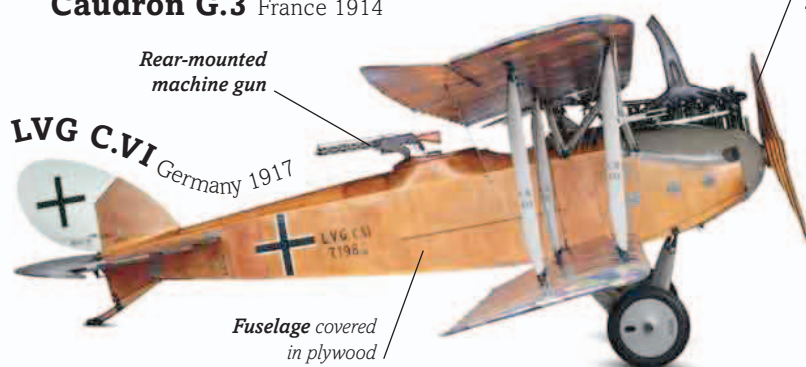
Wooden propeller 9ft (2.8m) in diameter



The G.3 was an **easy target** for WWI fighters due to its **slow** speed of 66 mph (106 km/h).

Rear-mounted machine gun

LVG C.VI Germany 1917



Fuselage covered in plywood

North American O-47B USA 1938



Pilot wears space suit in the cockpit for flying at high altitudes of 70,000ft (21,000m) above sea level

Wingspan of 46ft 5in (14m)



Radar detects approaching aircraft

Lockheed U-2 USA 1955

Piper L-4H Grasshopper USA 1944



Rear seat, where an observer could face forward or backward, with table for maps and radio

Reconnaissance planes scout the land and sea from above. Some go further, acting as spies in the sky using telephoto lenses and other tools to spot troop positions and detect enemy weapons, facilities, or other crucial activity on the ground.

The first spotter planes, such as the **Caudron G.3** and the **LVG C.VI**, were used to detect enemy artillery and troop movements. Later observation aircraft, such as the **OV-10 Bronco**, could scout territory and carry weapons. It could also take off from roads or makeshift runways,